

ENVS 193DS Final

Emilio Ojemann

2026-06-09

Table of contents

GitHub repository	2
Set Up	2
Problem 1. Research writing	2
a. Transparent statistical methods	2
b. Suggestions for rewriting	3
c. Further analysis	3
Problem 2. Data analysis	3
a. Clean and wrangle	3
b. Response variable	4
c. Purpose of study	4
d. Table of models	5
e. Running the models	6
f. Selecting the best model	6
g. Checking the diagnostics	6
h. Visualizing model predictions	6
i. Writing figure caption	6
j. Calculating model predictions	6
k. Interpreting results	6
Problem 3. Affective and exploratory visualizations	6
a. Comparing visualizations	6
b. Designing an analysis	6
c. Checking assumptions and running analysis	6
d. Creating a visualization	6
e. Writing a caption	6
f. Writing about results	6

GitHub repository

Set Up

Created repository, added description and README

```
# read in packages
library(tidyverse)
library(here)
library(janitor)
library(DHARMA)
library(ggeffects)
library(MuMIn)
library(scales)

# read in nest observation data

nests <- read_csv(here("data", "nest_data_final.csv"))

# read in personal dinner cooking data
```

Problem 1. Research writing

a. Transparent statistical methods

In part 1, they used a binomial generalized linear model (aka logistic). The response is a binary outcome: the probability of American Avocet microhabitat use (it either is used or it is not). The predictor is distance to water edge, so it is continuous. This makes sense to use a binomial GLM to test whether a continuous predictor variable relates to a binary response.

In part 2, they used a chi-square test. Both the response (habitat type, 5 levels) and the predictor (bird species, 3 levels) variables are categorical. It makes sense to use chi-square because they are seeing if a relationship exists between categories.

b. Suggestions for rewriting

Part 1: The probability that American Avocet's use microhabitat depends on how far the microhabitat is from the water's edge

Part 2: There is a difference in the habitats that the three bird species (American Avocet, Forster's Tern, and Black-necked Stilt) use, so there are some species that are found in certain habitats more than others.

c. Further analysis

An additional variable that might influence the probability of American Avocet microhabitat use is the **water depth**. This is a continuous variable, measured in centimeters with a marked pole. As with most wading birds, American Avocets primarily feed by sweeping their bills through the water. It is thus likely that a microhabitat with shallower water will be used more than one with deep water, as it is easier to feed in.

Problem 2. Data analysis

a. Clean and wrangle

```
# create new object using nest data frame
nests_clean <- nests |>
  # keep only the Crematogaster ant species
  filter(ant_species %in% c("AB", "RRB", "BBR")) |>
  # create new column with the full scientific name
  mutate(scientific_name = case_match(
    ant_species,
    "AB" ~ "Crematogaster sjostedti",
    "RRB" ~ "Crematogaster mimosae",
    "BBR" ~ "Crematogaster nigriceps"
  )) |>
  # set the level order
  mutate(scientific_name = as_factor(scientific_name),
         scientific_name = fct_relevel(scientific_name,
                                       "Crematogaster sjostedti",
                                       "Crematogaster mimosae",
                                       "Crematogaster nigriceps")) |>

# keep the three relevant columns
select(case_control, height_cm, scientific_name)
```

```
# display the structure of the cleaned data frame
str(nests_clean)
```

```
tibble [270 x 3] (S3: tbl_df/tbl/data.frame)
 $ case_control   : num [1:270] 1 0 0 0 0 1 0 0 0 1 ...
 $ height_cm      : num [1:270] 392 310 513 154 324 ...
 $ scientific_name: Factor w/ 3 levels "Crematogaster sjostedti",...: 2 2 2 2 1 2 3 2 1 3 ...
```

```
# show 10 random rows
slice_sample(nests_clean, n = 10)
```

```
# A tibble: 10 x 3
  case_control height_cm scientific_name
      <dbl>      <dbl> <fct>
1         0      310  Crematogaster mimosae
2         1     288.  Crematogaster mimosae
3         0     136.  Crematogaster mimosae
4         0     164.  Crematogaster nigriceps
5         0     156   Crematogaster sjostedti
6         0     242.  Crematogaster mimosae
7         0     128   Crematogaster mimosae
8         0     368   Crematogaster mimosae
9         0     119   Crematogaster mimosae
10        0     150   Crematogaster mimosae
```

b. Response variable

The 1s and 0s in the “case_control” column tell if a tree had a bird nest or not. A 1 means the tree was observed to have one and the 0 meant the tree was an available tree without a nest.

c. Purpose of study

Tree height is a continuous variable measured in centimeters. As the tree height increases, the probability of a nest occurring should increase too, because it physically places a nest farther up from the ground and its predators. The paper did find that the probability of a bird nesting in a tree increased with height, as described in the *Results* section, *second* paragraph.

Acacia ant species is a categorical variable with three levels (C. sjostedti, C. mimosae, and C. nigriceps). It makes sense that the probability of nest occurring should depend on the ant

species present in a tree. Trees that are defended by more aggressive ant species are more likely to have a nest because of the protection it will receive. The paper highlights this in the *Discussion* section, *first* paragraph.

d. Table of models

Model number	Model description
1	tree height and ant species as predictors, with an interaction term
2	tree height and ant species as predictors, without an interaction term

- e. Running the models
- f. Selecting the best model
- g. Checking the diagnostics
- h. Visualizing model predictions
- i. Writing figure caption
- j. Calculating model predictions
- k. Interpreting results

Problem 3. Affective and exploratory visualizations

- a. Comparing visualizations
- b. Designing an analysis
- c. Checking assumptions and running analysis
- d. Creating a visualization
- e. Writing a caption
- f. Writing about results
- g. Sharing affective visualization